GROWTH CAPITAL #002 · THURSDAY

Ather Energy. ₹1,300 Cr into a company that still loses money.

Series · Growth Capital (Thu) **Date** · 30 Jul 2026 **Subject** · Ather Energy

Framework · Fund the leader before the profit

01 Carousel caption (posts 08:00 IST)

Why would India's biggest funds pour ₹1,300 crore into a company that still loses money?

Ather Energy just raised ₹1,300 crore in a QIP. The buyers weren't gamblers. They were HDFC, Axis and Tata mutual funds, and the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority. Some of the most careful money in the country.

And Ather isn't profitable. Last quarter it lost ₹154 crore. So what did they see?

They looked past this quarter's P&L and at the direction of every number that matters. Revenue: up 54% year on year. Market share in EV two-wheelers: up to 17%, from 12%. Losses: shrinking, not growing.

That's the whole logic of growth capital. Early-stage money buys a founder and an idea. Growth capital buys a leader that's already winning share and just needs fuel to reach profit. You're not funding what the company earns today. You're funding the slope of the line.

Here's the catch most people miss. A slope is a promise, not a fact. Ather is in a price war with Ola, TVS and Bajaj. Market share means nothing until it turns into margin. Growth capital is a bet that leadership converts.

The lesson: at this stage, momentum is worth more than a clean balance sheet, as long as it keeps compounding.

💬 Would you fund the company growing fastest, or the one already making money?
❤️ Save this before your next raise.

📚 Sources: StartupTalky, Business Standard, Tracxn
⚠️ Editorial analysis of publicly available information. Not investment advice.

#startup #venturecapital #growthcapital #ather #startupindia

SEO Keywords (one line, comma-separated, for captions, alt text, cross-posting, YouTube/blog)

ather energy funding, ather ₹1300 crore qip, ather energy qip 2026, growth capital india, why investors fund loss making startups, ather energy market share, electric scooter startup india, ev two wheeler market, growth stage funding, abu dhabi investment authority india, startup funding india, ather energy ipo, venture capital vs growth capital, funding the category leader, ather energy revenue, startupsutra growth capital, how startups raise growth capital, indian ev startups, qualified institutional placement, momentum over profit investing

02 Reel caption (evening · single reel, reversal hook)

REEL · REVERSAL HOOK

Everyone thinks investors only fund profitable companies. India's biggest funds just handed a loss-making one ₹1,300 crore.

Ather Energy still loses money, ₹154 crore last quarter. But HDFC, Axis, Tata and the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority wrote the cheque anyway. Because revenue is up 54%, market share climbed to 17%, and losses are shrinking.

Growth capital doesn't buy this quarter's profit. It buys the leader before the profit shows up.

💬 Growth or profit, which would you fund?
📚 Sources: StartupTalky, Business Standard. ⚠️ Not investment advice.

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03 Alt text 7 slides

1. **1.** Growth Capital, Ather Energy. It still loses money every quarter, and India's biggest funds just handed it ₹1,300 crore.
2. **2.** Snapshot: Ather Energy, based in Bengaluru, raised ₹1,300 crore in a QIP, backed by HDFC, Axis and Tata mutual funds and the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority, building electric scooters.
3. **3.** The anomaly: Ather hasn't turned a profit; last quarter it lost ₹154 crore. So why would sober institutions pour in ₹1,300 crore.
4. **4.** The signal: the numbers that matter are all bending the right way. Revenue up 54 percent, market share up to 17 percent, losses shrinking. Growth capital buys the trajectory, not this quarter's P&L.
5. **5.** The metrics: 17.4 percent EV two-wheeler share up from 12, revenue up 54 percent year on year, loss narrowed to ₹154 crore from ₹197 crore, and ₹1,300 crore of fresh growth capital.
6. **6.** The risks people miss: Ather is still burning cash, in a price war with Ola, TVS and Bajaj, and market share means nothing until it converts to margin.
7. **7.** Decoded: growth capital doesn't buy profit, it buys the leader before profit arrives. Momentum can be worth more than a clean P&L. Follow @statupsutra, Growth Capital on Thursdays.

04 Hashtags, Stories & timing

CORE

#startup #venturecapital #growthcapital #ather #startupindia

EXTENDED

#ev #electricvehicles #electricscooter #atherenergy #startupfunding #vc #entrepreneurship #india #cleantech

Stories: teaser (number) "someone just raised ₹1,300 Cr while losing money. Guess who 👀" → follow-up "Would you have backed this round? Yes/No" → This-or-That "Fund growth or fund profit?". Tag **@atherenergy** in first comment.

LOCKED SCHEDULE (IST)

TIME	ASSET
08:00	**Carousel**, slides 1 to 7
~18:00	**Story** teaser (number)
20:00	**Reel** (reversal hook)
20:05	**Story** follow-up

One reel only. Reply to every comment within the hour.